

CONTENTS

1	Why Most Prompts Fail	3
2	The CORELITE System	5
3	Prompt Patterns	9
4	Quick-Copy Prompt Sheet	12

Before You Start

Not theory. Not hype. Every technique here was tested by a real student with real deadlines.

Copy the prompts. Test them today. The difference between a good prompt and a bad one is hours saved.

Joy Roy, AI Blog Factory

Why 90% of Prompts Fail

Understanding the gap between what you type and what AI hears.

Most students type something vague, get a mediocre answer, and blame the tool. The tool is not the problem. The prompt is.

The Google Habit

- "Tell me about ML" -> Generic overview, any depth, any format
- "Explain ML to a first-year with 3 examples" -> Targeted, concrete, actionable
- "Help me with my assignment" -> Hundreds of assignments fit. Impossible to help.
- "I am writing a 500-word essay on supervised vs unsupervised learning for my intro CS class" -> AI knows exactly what you need.

The Fix

Add three things to vague prompts: WHO you are, WHAT format you need, HOW LONG it should be.

TIP: QUICK TEST

Replace "Tell me about X" with "Explain X to a [year]-year student. Give [N] real-world examples and one analogy."

The CORELITE System

Seven elements that transform any question into a perfect prompt.

You do not need all seven every time. Knowing them means you always know what to add.

C - Context

Background. 'I am a third-year engineering student.'

O - Objective

Specific outcome. 'I need to understand this well enough to solve exam problems.'

R - Response format

Essay? Code? Bullets? 'Give me 3 examples with steps.'

E - Examples

Show good output. 'Like this: [paste]. Now do [topic].'

L - Length

50 words or 500? 'Under 150 words.'

I - Intent

Why? 'Preparing for a midterm in 3 days.'

T - Tone

Be conversational but accurate.'

E - Edge cases

What to exclude? 'No calculus-level derivations.'

TIP: REMEMBER

Context + Objective + Response covers 80% of situations.

Five Prompt Patterns

Structures that work across every subject.

Expert Role-Play

"Act as a [role]. Explain [topic] to [audience]." Best for explanations from a specific perspective.

Chain-of-Thought

Add "Let us think step by step" - Improves accuracy 40%+ on hard problems.

Few-Shot

Give 2-3 examples of desired output, then ask. Powerful for specific formats.

Iterative Refine

Round 1: General. Round 2: "Go deeper." Round 3: "Real example." Round 3 is where value is.

Debate Mode

"Argue for X. Then argue against it." Perfect for essays and critical thinking.

Prompt Sheet + Debugging

10 essential prompts. How to fix bad answers.

10 Quick-Copy Prompts

EXPLAINER: 'Explain [topic] like I am a beginner. Give 2 examples, 1 analogy.'

ESSAY: 'Outline a [X]-word essay on [topic] with [N] sections and a thesis.'

CODE FIX: 'I got this error: [paste]. My code: [paste]. Explain simply.'

STUDY: 'Quiz me on [topic]. 10 questions, increasing difficulty. Grade each.'

FLASHCARDS: 'Create 15 flashcards from: [paste notes].'

COMPARE: 'Compare [A] vs [B] in a table: feature, pros, cons, best for.'

EMAIL: 'Write a polite email to [person] about [request].'

SUMMARIZE: 'Summarize this in [X] words: [paste].'

DEBATE: 'Argue for [position]. Then argue against it. Which is stronger?'

CREATIVE: 'Give me 10 creative ideas for [project] about [topic].'

Debugging Bad Answers

- Too Generic? -> Add specifics: who you are, the exact question, format needed.
 - Too Long? -> Add constraints: "In 3 bullet points." "Under 100 words."
 - Wrong Tone? -> "Explain like a peer." "Be formal and academic."
 - Wrong Depth? -> "I am a beginner." "Give expert-level detail."
 - Seems Fake? -> Ask for sources: "Cite your sources."
-

YOU HAVE THE SYSTEM.

Better prompts. Better results. Less wasted time.